Skill – Performance (Charisma) · SRD 5.2.1

Performance is used to **entertain and captivate**: singing, dancing, acting, music. It uses a **Charisma (Performance)** check via the **Influence** action, with or without an instrument.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **Charisma (Performance)** check.
2. **Influence** action.
3. A proficient instrument can grant Advantage.
4. Earns money or attention.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 places Performance under Influence and notes Advantage with a proficient instrument.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't value a performance's earnings. Fix: the DM sets earnings by result.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the audience's reaction (silence, ovation) to illustrate the result.

Step 1 – Announce:

The player says what they play or sing.

Step 2 – Audience:

The DM judges the audience and venue.

Step 3 – Set the DC:

DC 10 mediocre; 15 decent; 20 exceptional.

Step 4 – Roll:

1d20 + Charisma + proficiency (Advantage with a proficient instrument).

Step 5 – Resolve:

Success: the audience is captivated; failure: indifference.

Example: Mira plays a lute in the tavern (DC 15). She rolls 18: she earns a few coins and the patrons' ear.

⚠ Common questions:

Is an instrument required?

No, but Advantage if proficient.

What do I gain?

Attention, money or a class effect.

Can I distract?

Yes: a check to draw attention.

Against an enemy?

Can distract them at a high DC.

How long?

Depends on the performance.

Retry?

A new performance is possible.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Earnings

How much for an evening? **Option**: 1 to 10 gp by result.

Magic

Charm with music? **Option**: not without a spell.

Hostile audience

Raised DC. **Option**: Disadvantage.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Influence

Performance uses the Influence action.

Instrument

A proficient instrument grants Advantage.

Earnings

Earnings depend on result and venue.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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